ONTARIO CYCLING

PROLOGUE
"ACE YOUR RACE"
CYCLOCROSS

Technical Guide

Sunday, October 18, 2026

UXBRIDGE CYCLING CLUB

EXODUS GRAPHICS

pcc Peterborough Cycling Club



The Prologue: What you really need to know

While Prologue is a sanctioned Ontario Cycling Ontario Cup cyclocross event with a proper CX Technical Race Guide, don't let that intimidate you. If you're new to cross and just want to show up and have fun, here's what really matters:

1. **Find a bike** — almost anything works except a fancy road bike. MTB, gravel, CX, single speed, even a strider! Racers in Category A – see below.
2. **Just want to try it out?** Join the **untimed Try-a-CX ride** at 12:00. Cost is $20 cash for adults (kids <13 are free). No pre-registration required.
3. **Want to race for real?** Register by midnight on **Thursday, Oct 15**. Categories follow the OC CX structure. Quick guide if you're new:
    - Men: Category A = most challenging, Category B = intermediate, Category C = least challenging.
    - Women: Category A = most challenging, Category B = less challenging.
    - Masters Men & Women: separate 35+ and 55+ categories.
    - Youth: U13, U15 and U17. Register based on your age as of Dec. 31, 2027. For example, U13 means age 12 or younger as of Dec. 31, 2027.
    - Single Speed: a separate category for single-speed bikes.
4. **Show up on race day, Oct 18** — arrive at least 1 hour before your start time to sign in, get yourself sorted, and maybe pre-ride or warm up. See page 4 of this guide for the location and map.
5. **Stick around after** — enjoy snacks, cider or beer, sport drink for riders, a free physio treatment, music, and all the good vibes.

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Event Description

Date & Location

Date: Sunday, October 18, 2026

Time: 8:00 am – 3:30 pm

Location: 55 Elgin Park Dr, Uxbridge, ON L9P 1Z6

Parking: Parking is permitted in the designated area accessible from 55 Elgin Park Dr. as shown in the Course/Venue map. Participants may not to park in the 180 Main St S. parking area.

Event Contacts

Position	Name
Event Organizer	Franny Jewett (Uxbridge Cycling Club) E: **franny@jewett.ca**
Ontario Cycling Event Lead	Darren De Ruiter E: **events.team@ontariocycling.org**
Ontario Cycling Membership	Chris Baskys E: **info@ontariocycling.org**
Timing	**racetiming.ca**
Medical	St. John's Ambulance

Commissaires:

Position	Name
President of the Commissaire Panel	Marie-Eve Potvin
Finish Judge	Kevin Scheerer
Member	Maria Paisley

Registration

- Registration is open to all participants regardless of age
- Early bird discount of $15 for registration by Oct. 4, 2026 at 11:59 pm

- Registration for timed events closes on Thursday, Oct. 15 at 11:59 pm
- Registration is open on race day for the non-sanctioned activities (women's guided pre-ride, try-a-ride and the kids-course race).
- Riders looking to register for multiple races can do so by selecting multiple categories when registering online. A 30% discount will be applied when registering for more than one category. If racing a main category and single speed, the total cost is similar to a $25 single speed add-on registration.

Licensing Requirements

- Cat A and Cat A Women are required to hold UCI or OC Compete licenses to be eligible. Anyone without those memberships that register for Cat A and Cat A Women will be moved to Cat B.
    - US licensed racers must hold a UCI International license. For insurance reasons, a USA cycling license is not sufficient and is not permitted in Canada.
    - All foreign licensed riders, other than US riders must produce a letter of permission from their country's federation. This must be submitted to Ontario Cycling 72 hours in advance of the event and a copy must be provided on race day to the President of the Commissaire Panel.
- Riders without an OC membership are able to participate in all other categories.
- An OC representative will be present at the race to assist with rider licensing issues. Licenses will not be sold on race day.

Pre-Riding

- Course pre-riding is available on Saturday, Oct 17 4:00-6:00 pm at no charge for registered participants, or for a fee of $10 without a registration.
- Course pre-riding is also available on race day Sunday, Oct. 18. 20-to-30-minute time breaks between start waves have been worked into the schedule to allow all riders to have an equal opportunity to ride 1 or more laps of the course prior to their race start.
- Riders are only permitted to pre-ride the course when either no race is currently on the course or behind the last rider in the current race on course on their final lap.
- Pre-riders must not interfere with the current race unfolding, any riders who are found to have interfered with or passed the last rider of the current race on course may be subject to receiving a fine or disqualified from competing in their race later in the day.
- Any person who rides the course outside of the pre-riding or race day designated times assumes their own risk and responsibility when riding.

Bib Numbers

- Riders will receive new bib numbers when they sign in.
- Please ask for a second timing chip for your pit bike. All timing chips are to be returned at the end of race completion.
- Bibs are to be placed on both arms and the RIGHT back side of the jersey. Please refer to below diagram.



Categories, Pricing, Schedule, Tire Width

- OCup categories for riders 17+ are ability-based where athletes self-seed themselves from Categories A-C and Categories A & B (Women Only), based on their ability and experience level. Women who would like to race in Categories A-C are able to do so. The ability-based format is designed to provide meaningful competition for all riders and help ensure appropriate participant numbers for quality racing.
- Youth categories for riders under 17 years of age as of Dec. 31st, 2027 remain with age groups U17 (15-16), U15 (13-14), and U13 (8- 12). To calculate age for categorization, use age at Dec. 31, 2027.
- New for 2026* Masters age group categories for Men lower from 45+ in 2025 to 35+. This complements the addition of a separate Master 55+ category for both Men/Open and Women. Cat D is removed with C moving to the first start of the day to pair with the additional Master category, the Master 35+ category moving to the 11am start with Cat B.

- All riders must sign-in at the Sign-In Desk before their race. Sign-in closes 30 minutes prior to the start of each race wave.

Start Time	Category	Fee	Duration	Tire Width*
8:00 AM – 2:00 PM	Rider Sign In is Open			
Wave 1				
9:00 AM	Cat C	$70	40 min.	N/A
9:01	Master Men (55+)			
9:40	Break		20 min.	
Wave 2				
10:00	U17 Girls & Boys	$50	40 min.	N/A
10:01	U15 Girls & Boys		30-40 min.	
10:02	U13 Girls & Boys		30-40 min.	
10:40	Break Wave 1 Podium Ceremonies		20 min.	
Wave 3				
11:00	Cat B	$70	45 min.	N/A
11:01	Master Men (35+)			
11:45	Break Wave 2 Podium Ceremonies		15 min.	
Mid-Day Events				
12:00 PM	Women Only guided pre-ride	Free	25 min.	N/A
12:30	All Ages Untimed & Kids timed Try-A-Race	$20 Kids free	25 min.	
12:55	Break Wave 3 & Mid-Day Timed Race Podium Ceremonies		20 min.	
Wave 4				
1:15	Cat A Women	$70	45 min.	33 mm
1:16	Cat B Women		40 min.	N/A
	Masters Women (35+)		40 min.	
	Masters Women (55+)		40 min.	
2:00	Break		20 min.	
Wave 5				
2:20	Cat A	$70	60 min.	33 mm
2:21	Single Speed		45 min.	N/A
3:30	Wave 4 & 5 Podium Ceremonies		15 min.	

**At Ontario Cup events tire width courtesy checks will be performed for each corresponding category – U17, Cat A Women, & Cat A. No riders will be disqualified if their tire width does*

not conform to the 33mm maximum width at Ontario Cups. The categories most likely required to follow the UCI tire width restriction align with those that will be checked at National and Provincial Championships – U17, U19, U23, Elite, & Master. A tire width gauge will be made available to all riders at the sign-in desk to pre-check.

Staging & Start Protocol

- Riders will start in a Mass Start Format according to the above schedule.
- Start Corrals to open 10 minutes prior to start. Riders are reminded to follow instructions for maintaining proper distancing.
- Rider staging will begin 10 minutes prior to race start and call-ups 5 minutes prior. If you are not present for call-up you will forfeit your starting position.
- Race Officials will start each wave of the race.

Ontario Cup Call-Up Protocol

Call-ups for OCup categories are designed to encourage participation in the OCup series. The following is the protocol when using OCup points to determine the call-up order:

- Riders tied with the same number of OCup points will be randomized.
- After the first 2 rows are filled, any remaining riders will fill the additional places on the starting grid on a first-come, first-served basis.
- If the first 2 rows are not filled, other riders can take open positions.
- When two or more categories are combined in the same start wave (that is, start at the same time offset), those riders will be considered "in the same race". Call-ups will cycle between each category to fill the first 2 rows (1st, 1st, 1st, 2nd, 2nd, 2nd, 3rd, 3rd, 3rd, etc.).
- Riders with a mountain bike now forfeit a call-up for safer starts.

Prologue may recognize National or World Champions in their race. These acknowledgments will be done before the call-ups. Participants will then be called up by the procedure above only. Riders may choose any position on the grid after their call-up, including not taking a position until the remainder of the field is called up.

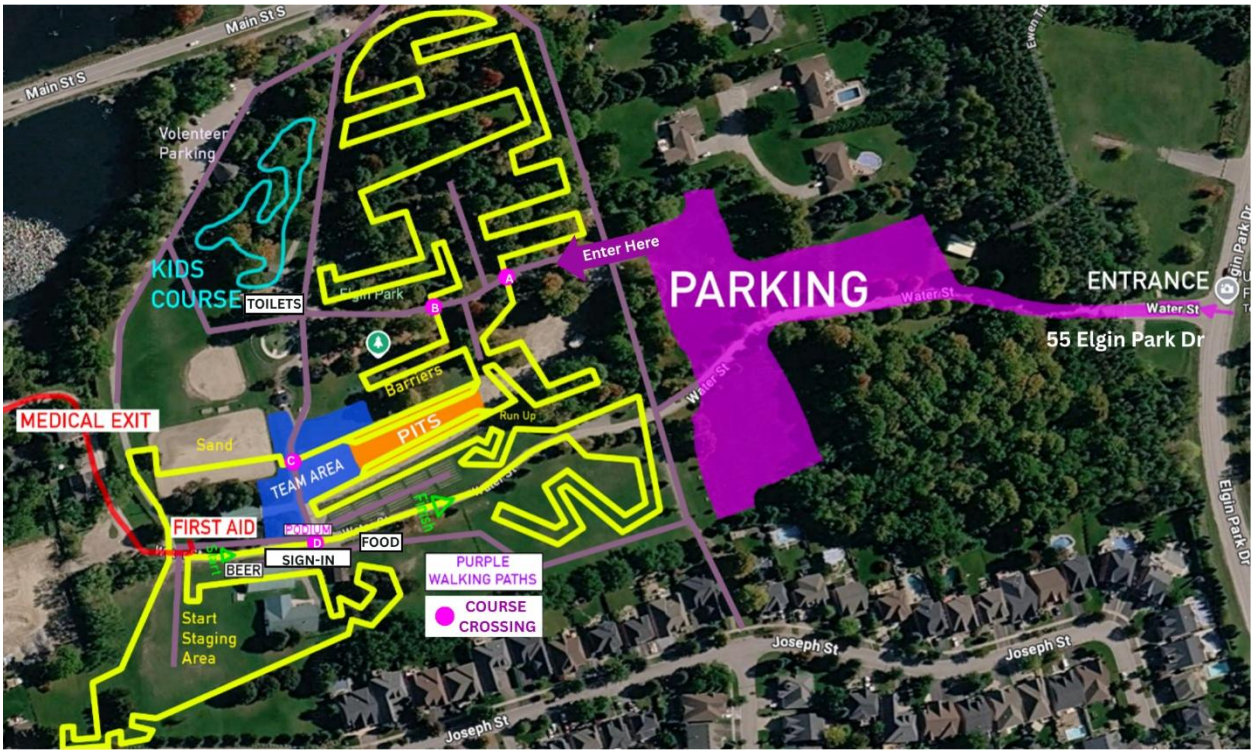
Results & Timing

- Prologue Cross will be timed by racetiming.ca. Race results will be available on Race Timing results page on event day at the link here: https://racetiming.ca/.
- Timing chips will be distributed that must be mounted on the fork. They MUST be returned after the rider's race is complete.

Awards & Prizes

- Awards will be presented to the top three (3) finishers in each category.
- Should categories be combined because of low participation numbers, results will be broken out for awards. Awards will be awarded based on the results of each category separated.
- Riders must attend the awards ceremonies or risk forfeiting their awards. Podium protocol shall be enforced, and fines may be issued to those who fail to comply. Riders must wear their competition uniform for medal presentations.
- Podium presentations will take place following the conclusion of each race as described in the race schedule.

Course Venue





Team Area

- Team space is available to all teams who wish to put up a team tent in the designated Team area.

Event Rules

On-Board Technology

The following are OC regulations for onboard technology for all OC events managed by OC Commissaires. These regulations do not apply to any events which do not require Commissaires, but if they are sanctioned under the OC Insurance Policy, Section 6 (a) and (b) applies.

1. All onboard technology device which is fitted on a bicycle must: 2026 Cyclocross Event Guidelines 18 5/22/26s
   - Be installed on a system designed specifically for bicycles and not affect the certification of any item on the bicycle.
   - Not cause a risk for the safety of any rider, and therefore, be affixed in a manner that ensures it is not susceptible of inadvertently dismounting or is non-removable.
   - The camera footage is not immediately available to the rider
2. Helmets must have a CSA certification. Any modification, alteration, manipulation, addition or removal of any element, or addition of an accessory unapproved by the helmet manufacturer is prohibited.
3. If the technology appears to be improperly affixed based on the commissaires discretion, the rider must remove or adjust the technology before the rider will be allowed to start.
4. If there is a crash during an event, permission must be secured in writing from the individuals involved before posting any footage from the incident.
5. It is strongly recommended that anyone who is using footage for individual promotion or private use, secure written consent in advance from any individual appearing on the footage.
6. Note:
   - Event Insurance does not cover loss or damage which may occur to onboard technology during the event.
   - All individuals using onboard technology are responsible and liable for any damage and injuries which may occur if the technology interferes with the integrity and safety of the event.

General Rules & Regulations

- The races will be governed under the current UCI Cyclo-Cross rules as amended by CC and OC. CC and OC rules are available online at https://ontariocycling.org/commissaire-resources/.
- The UCI penalty scale with CC and OC modifications will be used for any infractions.
- All riders must sign-in at registration on race day at least 30 minutes prior to their start.
- Races will start promptly at the indicated start times.
- Warming up on the course while a race is taking place is prohibited. As the lead rider crosses the finish line riders will be advised that they may enter with racers completing their last lap. Please be courteous to other racers above all else.
- Any rider dropping out of the race shall immediately notify a commissaire. If you drop out of a race and do not report to a commissaire, you will be considered and unreported DNF and assessed a penalty.
- A double-sided pit is located on course for servicing equipment and changing bikes or wheels. The pit must be accessed by the designated entrance and riders may not travel backwards or cut the course to reach the entrance, with the exception of a mishap occurring after the pit entrance but before the pit exit (travel back to pit entrance in this case).
- There is no neutral service provided but an on-site mechanic may be available to assist riders. Riders must supply their own spare wheels.
- Lapped riders may be pulled at the order of the commissaire, either after being overtaken or just before being overtaken.
- The 80% rule will be enforced at the discretion of the President of the Commissaire Panel.
- All riders finish on the same lap as the winner. The ringing of a bell will indicate the last lap.
- Results will be posted online at www.racetiming.ca shortly after each race.
- Upon posting there will be a 15-minute protest period after which time, the results will become official and award presentations will follow promptly.
- In case of lightning, the race may be delayed or cancelled. If you are informed that the race has been stopped due to lightning, you are advised to seek shelter until the race can resume. No refunds will be issued if the race is cancelled. If there are any changes or delays in the schedule.

- Consumption of alcohol by riders prior to their race is strictly prohibited. Any rider seen consuming alcohol before their race may be subject to a fine or disqualified from the event.

***New for 2026* Ontario Cup Points**

Ontario Cup points are awarded to the top 20 finishers in each category (formerly top 15). Only riders who have an OC membership are eligible for OCup points. Riders who DNF (do not finish) are not entitled to OCup points. Riders who move categories during the season will not carry any accumulated points into their new category. OCup points earned will remain in the category they were awarded within. Ontario Cup series champions will be decided by season ending OCup series point totals by a simple tally of all the points earned at OCup events for the current year.

To make the series title race tighter in 2026 and beyond, points awarded for each position have shrunk to a 1-point differential between each position (formerly a 2 or more-point differential between positions 1st-5th). Series points will be awarded as follows for all Ontario Cups:

Position	Points		Position	Points		Position	Points		Position	Points
1st	20		6th	15		11th	10		16th	5
2nd	19		7th	14		12th	9		17th	4
3rd	18		8th	13		13th	8		18th	3
4th	17		9th	12		14th	7		19th	2
5th	16		10th	11		15th	6		20th	1

**With 30 days or more notice to riders, double points can be offered.*
***Any riders competing with a non-member permit or residing out-of-province are not eligible to earn OCup points.*

With increased demand for OCup event hosting and greater variety of event type included within each series, Ontario Cycling is implementing a structure for lowest point score's to be dropped from the series ending points total dependent on how many events are held in a series. Where a riders lowest or zero (0) point scores from OCup events within a series are dropped from inclusion in the series total score according to the number of events held within the series for the year:

- 1-4 Events: All events are counted towards OCup points
- 5-6 Events: One (1) event is dropped from OCup points (event with least amount of points scored)
- 7+ Events: Two (2) events are dropped from OCup points (events with least amount of points scored)

OCup Points at Provincial Championships:

Riders will earn a 10-point bonus to their total 2026 OCup Points tally for registering in the respective disciplines 2026 Provincial Championships. Riders who do not register for provincials are not eligible. If a rider upgrades to a higher ability OCup category during the season (all OCup events in the season, does not include Provincials) and earns points in more than one category (i.e. Cat B for OCups 1-3 and Cat A for OCups 4-5), the 10-point bonus will only be applied to the highest ability category the rider scored points in during the OCup season (i.e., Cat A and not Cat B).

- Road & Cyclocross Series: Categories at Road & Cyclocross Provincials are different from OCups in that they are age-based and not ability-based, riders can choose to race in their respective age championship category or a nonchampionship category subject to having the applicable membership/license for the category (see licensing rules). If a rider decides to race in their age championship category at Provincials it is not constituted as an upgrade (i.e., a Cat B rider at all OCups [raced at 11:00am at all OCups] is of Elite age 23+ and decides to race in the Elite category at Provincials [1:30pm start time – same start time as Cat A at OCups] it is not seen that the rider 'upgraded' to Cat A, the rider simply decided to race in their age group and will receive the 10-point bonus for registering for Provincials to their Cat B points). For example, the final top three of an OCup category could look like

For example, the final top three of an OCup category could look like:

Name	OCup #1	OCup #2	OCup #3	OCup #4	OCup #5	OCup Total	Provincials	Final Points
Rider1	19 (2nd)	20 (1st)	18 (3rd)	20 (1st)	~~16 (5th)~~	77	10 (Yes)	87
Rider2	18 (3rd)	~~15 (6th)~~	20 (1st)	16 (5th)	17 (4th)	71	10 (Yes)	81
Rider3	20 (1st)	19 (2nd)	19 (2nd)	~~18 (3rd)~~	19 (2nd)	77	0 (No)	77

Tie Breaking Policy – Ontario Cup Series Points:

When two or more riders are tied at the end of the Ontario Cup series, the following criteria and procedure shall be utilized by the OC office to determine which rider is awarded the higher place in the standings. Descending through the following steps until one athlete emerges above the other:

1) Most race wins in the series.
2) Overall Points Average (number of points divided by events attended).

3) Highest placing in commonly attended events (who placed higher in the standings when both riders attended the same events).
4) Highest placing in the last event of the series.

Category Upgrades/Downgrades

Riders competing in Ontario Cup events are eligible to self-seed into the category they feel best matches their racing ability. If a rider decides that a race category is too difficult (or subsequently not difficult enough), they will be able to downgrade or upgrade at their discretion.

If a rider would like to upgrade age categories, for example U17 to Cat A (17+) they are required to submit a formal upgrade request via the OC upgrade form here. Age category upgrades require the submission of race results, experience, and other supporting information – to be eligible to submit an upgrade request riders must first meet the required criteria as listed in the form. All upgrade requests are subject to approval from the Ontario Cycling Upgrade Committee.

At Provincial Championships riders must race in their age group.

**Any age category upgrade approved by Ontario Cycling is for Ontario Cycling sanctioned events only. Those looking to upgrade for a National level event (including National Championships) must make this request to Cycling Canada.*

Ontario Cup Call-Up Protocol

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2) After the first 2 rows are filled, any remaining riders will fill the additional places on the starting grid on a first-come, first-served basis.
3) If the first 2 rows are not filled, other riders can take open positions.
4) When two or more categories are combined in the same start wave (that is, start at the same time offset), those riders will be considered "in the same race". Call-ups will cycle between each category to fill the first 2 rows (1st, 1st, 1st, 2nd, 2nd, 2nd, 3rd, 3rd, 3rd, etc.).

Organizers may acknowledge National or World Champions in their race. These acknowledgments will be done before the call-ups. Participants will then be called up by the procedure above only. Riders may choose any position on the grid after their call-up, including not taking a position until the remainder of the field is called up.

Equipment Regulations

- Cyclocross bicycles conforming with UCI regulations are required in the competitive Category A. In particular:
  - A bicycle shall not measure more than 185cm in length and 50cm in overall width.
  - Mountain bikes or bikes with flat-bar handlebars are not permitted.
  - Width of the tire shall not exceed 33mm and it may not incorporate any form of spike or stud.
- All other categories allow the use of any bicycle; including mountain bikes provided that bar ends are removed.
- Riders competing in race categories must wear the jersey of the team with which they are registered. Riders who are not affiliated with a team may wear a plain, unbranded jersey.
- At all times when warming up or participating in the event, riders who are mounted on a bicycle shall wear a helmet at all times.
- Two-way radios are reserved for race organization only.
- The use of radio links or other remote means of communication with the riders is forbidden.
- Riders may not use any form of radio communication while competing.
- Helmet mounted cameras are not permitted.
- The use of personal music players are not permitted while racing or warming up on the course.
- The use of glass containers is strictly prohibited during the race.

Technical Assistance Regulations

- Riders should be prepared to work on their bicycle outside of the PITS area / technical assistance zone. They can receive assistance in the technical zone only, or neutral support by the on-site mechanic.
- Small tools and tubes can be handed to people in the technical zone only.
- Anyone in the technical assistance zone may help riders to get their bicycle operational.
- Spare wheels are allowed in the PITS technical assistance zone only. Spare wheels cannot be stationed for use along the course other than in the tech zone.
- Riders are required to supply their own parts and equipment in the technical assistance zone. Riders may not take other participants equipment without their permission.

- Riders may carry tools and spare parts, provided that these do not involve any danger to the rider themselves or other competitors.

Bad Weather and Course Changes

- Changes to the course may be required in case of severe weather or changing atmospheric conditions. Changes will be announced at the start of all races. In all conditions riders should ensure they are riding within their limits and dismount if the terrain exceeds their technical comfort level.
- In the case of severe weather requiring a change of schedule, an email will be sent out to all participants, and information will be posted on Ontario Cycling's social media accounts.
- View OC's Weather Policy & Guideline Here

Spectator Safety & First Aid

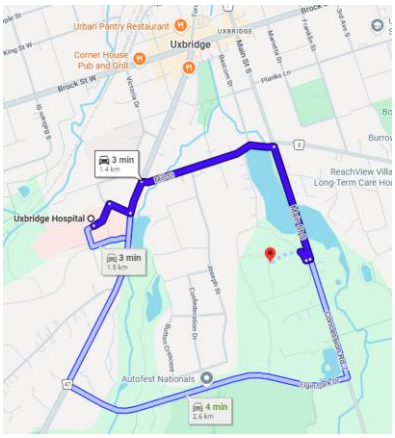
First Aid will be provided on site by St. John's Ambulance. They will be stationed near the start/finish area and at strategic location(s) on course at the discretion of the First Aid provider. Course maintenance volunteers will be on course at all times to make sure the competition area maintains consistent for all races.

Spectating is allowed along the courses behind safety tape. Spectators should stand a minimum of 3 feet behind tape and use caution when taking photos/videos due to depth perception. Tape although providing a visual boundary for course limits does not provide significant physical protection from riders breaking through and contacting features, objects, or people outside of course limits.

Medical / Hospital

Uxbridge Cottage Hospital, (905) 852-9771

4 Campbell Dr, Uxbridge, ON L9P 1S4



Event Sponsors



